

Second World War

*World War II started in September 1939 A.D., Congress demanded the independence of India for India's participation in the war. Then Viceroy **Lord Linlithgow** threw India into the war without the consent of Congress and declared an emergency in the country. *Congress working committee asked for the announcement of objectives of war and also demanded India's Independence after war. *Congress passed a proposal and condemned the attack of Nazi on Poland also lashed the ideology of Nazism and Fascism. It stated that India could not be a part of any war that is fought for the protection of democracy because India itself is struggling to achieve independence from the British colonial rule. ***Lord Linlithgow** on **17th October, 1939** A.D. announced that India will be standing against Germany in the war. Without the authorization of Indian Provincial Cabinets, India's inclusion in the War led to the resignation of all Congress provincial cabinets. *Second World War started with Germany attacking Poland on **1st September, 1939** and ended after six years in September 1945. *Neville Chamberlain and **Winston Churchill** were the British Prime Ministers during World War II (1939-1945 AD). Churchill's tenure was from the year 1940 to 1945 and 1951 to 1955.

1. What was the policy of Indian National Congress during IInd World War?

- (a) Cooperation of Britain in the case of assurance of Complete Independence.
- (b) Active collaboration of British (Britain)
- (c) Neutrality
- (d) None of the above.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

When World War II broke out in 1939 A.D., Britain made India belligerent without consulting Indian elected councils and also declared the Emergency. That action angered Indian officials and prompted the Congress Party to declare that India would not support the war until it had been granted complete independence.

2. Statement (S) : Indian National Congress had collaborated/assisted British in IInd World War.

Reason (R) : Because they were expecting to complete independence.

Code :

- (a) (S) and (R) are individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (S).
- (b) Both (S) and (R) are false.

- (c) (S) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (R) is true, but (S) is false.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (b)

During the Second World War the proposal approved by Indian National Congress criticized Nazism, Fascism and the Nazi invasion of Poland. It was declared under the proposal that Indian could not take part in any such war which is being fought to protect the democratic liberty, while itself being deprived of liberty. Therefore, both the statement and the reason are incorrect.

3. Assertion (A) : The Congress Ministries in all the provinces resigned in the year 1939.

Reason (R) : The Congress did not accept the decision of the Viceroy to declare war against Germany in the context of the Second World War.

Code:

- (a) (A) and (R) are individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) (A) and (R) are individually true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) Both (A) and (R) are false.
- (d) (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

On October 17, 1939 A.D. Lord Linlithgow declared India in the war against Germany. Congress cabinets had resigned from all the provinces for declaring war without the consent of the Congress Ministries. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

4. The Congress Ministries in all the provinces resigned in the year 1939, because :

- (a) Congress was unable to make a cabinet in other four provinces.
- (b) The rise of the left wing of Congress made impossible to work for the cabinet.
- (c) There was too much communal turbulence in the provinces
- (d) None of the above is true from the given statement (a), (b), (c).

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

After 28 months of tenure, the cabinets of Congress resigned in 1939 A.D. because British Government had declared India as a war-torn country without the consent of Indians. Thus, option (d) is true.